

Metro Communications: central Illinois fiber; a wholesale route partner

Partner activation plan for Spencer Refer | Prepared Thursday, October 1, 2026 | Sources: HubSpot, Lemlist, ZoomInfo

Sullivan, IL HQ	100 Networking/Telecom intent, audience A	~31 employees	Tier A partner priority
STAGE Carrier partner: recruit.	RUNNING NOW Not in a campaign	LAST TOUCH None logged	NEXT STEP Tue Oct 6: email Zak Horn (President)

Bottom line

Metro Communications runs **the largest independent fiber network in central Illinois** (about 31 people, Sullivan, IL). ZoomInfo shows **Networking/Telecom intent at 100 (audience A)**. A carrier like this needs a Chicago handoff for its wholesale and enterprise customers. **A Crosstown and Metro Communications pairing gives both a central-Illinois-to-Chicago story**, useful for accounts like NCSA in Urbana. **Zak Horn (President)** is in HubSpot.

What this partner is, in one analogy

Metro owns the country roads; Crosstown owns the city streets. Connect them, and both get more traffic.

Signals worth citing

Signal	Source	So what for the opener
Largest independent fiber network in central Illinois	ZoomInfo	Wholesale route partner.
Networking/Telecom 100 (A)	ZoomInfo intent	Active network planning.

Work already in motion

Partner activity so far.

When	Channel / campaign	What happened	Read
-	-	No campaign yet	-

Who to reach, in order

Contact	Title (source)	Where	Why they matter	Status / email
Zak Horn	President (HubSpot)	Sullivan, IL	Decision maker.	Not contacted

Not worth chasing for this goal

Their end clients directly; never go around a partner.

How the access path should run

Intro 15-30 minutes	→	Partner kit KMZ, building list, terms	→	Deal review One Chicago opportunity	→	First referral 90 days
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Messages, by contact

1. Zak Horn President

Why them: Decision maker.

Channel: Email Tue Oct 6 | Subject: Central Illinois to Chicago: Metro and Crosstown

Zak, Metro owns central Illinois fiber; Crosstown owns underground fiber in Chicago, on-net at Cermak, Elk Grove and Polk. Together that's a downstate-to-Chicago path neither of us can sell alone. Worth a call about wholesale handoffs?

The plan

When	Move	Notes
Tue Oct 6	Email Zak Horn.	-
Week of Oct 19	Call; map the handoff options.	Engineering.
Nov	Wholesale agreement draft.	Tony.

What progress looks like (for management)

By	Milestone	How we will know
Oct 16	Intro call held	Meeting logged
Nov 30	First opportunity shared	Partner-sourced deal

Guardrails

- Carrier relationship: use a wholesale or reciprocal agreement, not the agency agreement.
- Credits used: ZoomInfo company and signals for 1 company.

Sources

HubSpot contacts; Lemlist partner campaigns; ZoomInfo firmographics and signals.